



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Wyoming Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.wyoclassical.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Wyoming Classical Academy (WCA) presents a clearly articulated classical orientation centered on virtue, moral character, and a liberal-arts based curriculum. Public-facing materials emphasize character formation, civic virtue, and a content-rich classical education built on liberal arts and sciences. The mission explicitly frames education as formation of minds and hearts, not merely information transfer, with aims toward virtuous citizenship. This aligns substantially with classical aims, but the materials reviewed do not prominently assert theology, liturgical practices, or explicit Great Books/Great Conversation rhetoric, and there is limited evidence of canonical classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, routine Great Books study) in the public pages. Taken together, the school lands between CLASSICAL and SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with the aggregate leaning toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to partial gaps in the explicit articulation of core classical practices beyond virtue-centric formation and liberal-arts emphasis.

- Strengths: Clear emphasis on virtue, moral character, civic virtue, and a liberal-arts, content-rich classical framework. Public materials foreground formation of character and a well-rounded liberal arts education (evidence: Vision & Mission and day-to-day descriptions) ,.
- Elementary evidence of classical pedagogy or canonical elements is present but not consistently explicit (e.g., no direct public statements of Great Books, daily Socratic seminars, or liturgical practices across the public site) ,.
- Parent and community engagement is actively promoted (parent information nights, open enrollment, and visitor access), which aligns with the classical model's emphasis on parental partnership and communal support ,.

Executive category snapshot highlights: Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal) and Element 6 (Parents & Community) are CLASSICAL based on explicit formation aims and strong parent engagement. Categories 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations), 3 (Curriculum), 4 (Pedagogy), and 5 (Faculty) show substantial classical signals but with gaps that keep them at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The aggregate assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle: - Explicitly articulate and weave in Great Books / Great Conversation language and programs (e.g., mention of Great Books in core history and literature, a formal Great Conversation framework). - Add explicit articulation of Socratic pedagogy in upper grades and clear, scheduled Socratic seminars/public-facing descriptions. - Strengthen explicit theology or spiritual formation language (where appropriate for the charter context) and liturgical or communal practices as part of the daily rhythm, if consistent with the school's identity. - Provide a public, concrete statement of the living curriculum and teacher-mentorship expectations (the living curriculum, teacher modeling of virtue, and mentorship) to strengthen Element 5.

Note: The following section provides category-by-category keyword analyses, with the six-category rubric applied using Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements document.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Vision emphasizes virtue and moral character as foundational aims (virtue, moral character, civic virtue appear in public materials) and frames education as forming virtuous, civic citizens. - No explicit theological grounding or liturgical practices are stated in the public mission statements; the materials foreground moral character and civic virtue rather than theology or sacred rites (as presented in the Vision & Mission).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, moral character, civic virtue (3 instances aligning with Transcendental Moral Realism and formation of affections). - Negative keywords present: none clearly evidenced in public materials (no explicit absence claim about theology or liturgy is stated on the site).

Why this rating - The school foregrounds transcendental moral aims (virtue and character formation) but does not publicize theology, liturgical practices, or direct metaphysical/theological grounding. The keywords map to a moral-realism orientation (virtue and character) without explicit theological anchoring. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, given partial alignment and the absence of explicit liturgical/theological statements in the public content. The primary classical signals (virtue, moral formation) are present, but not the full theological and liturgical scaffolding called out in the rubric.

Citations: Vision & Mission content shows moral formation emphasis (virtue, moral character, civic virtue).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission states an aim to provide “a content-rich classical education that will train the minds and improve the hearts... through the liberal arts and sciences with instruction in the principles of moral character and civic virtue.” This strongly preserves formation (virtue and wisdom) over mere job preparation and emphasizes humanity and virtue as ends of education. - The Vision reiterates forming virtuous, responsible, joyful citizens ready to preserve a free republic, underscoring formation of character and civic responsibility beyond mere job prep.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, moral character, civic virtue, formation, humanity, wisdom (implicitly via formation-focused language), truth/goodness/beauty are suggested by the classical framing although not all are explicitly named in the text. - Negative keywords present: none explicitly shown in public materials (no claims of “job-focused” or “values-neutral” framing are present in the public Mission/Vision statements).

Why this rating - The materials clearly articulate formation of virtue and wisdom as the primary aim, not job prep, aligning with Classical education’s purpose and goal. The explicit framing of moral character and civic virtue, along with the language of forming well-rounded, virtuous citizens, supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Vision and Mission texts (virtue, moral character, civic virtue) ,.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe a “content-rich classical education” built on liberal arts and sciences, signaling a liberal-arts-centric curriculum foundation , and a well-rounded liberal arts education is highlighted in the day-to-day description of a typical day (reading, comprehension, eloquence, mathematics). - Explicit references to Great Books, Great Conversation, or the triad of grammar-logic-rhetoric are not publicly stated on the pages reviewed, though the emphasis on reading, speaking, and writing eloquently implies engagement with language arts and rhetoric to some degree.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, classical education, well-rounded liberal arts education, reading/comprehension, speaking/writing eloquently, content-rich (4 or more implied matches: liberal arts, classical education, well-rounded, reading/comprehension, eloquence in speaking/writing). - Negative keywords present: none explicitly stated on the pages reviewed (no explicit mention of Great Books or a formal triad in the public materials).

Why this rating - The curriculum is described in broad classical terms (liberal arts and a content-rich classical education), with explicit emphasis on reading, comprehension, eloquence, and mathematics. However, explicit naming of grammar, logic, and rhetoric as foundational curricular pillars, or explicit mention of Great Books/Great Conversation, is not clearly stated in the public materials. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Vision/Mission description of “content-rich classical education” and liberal arts ; Day-to-day goals citing a well-rounded liberal arts education and eloquence in speaking/writing.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a well-rounded set of outcomes (readers who comprehend, speakers who speak eloquently) suggesting a pedagogy that values memory, language, and literate communication; this points toward reflective and rhetorical aims in teaching practice (concrete signals: “read and comprehend well, speak and write eloquently”). - There is no explicit, public statement describing the use of Socratic seminars, debates, or classical seminars in higher grades, though the claim of a classical education implies some traditional methods may be employed. Public pages do not confirm a consistent use of Socratic pedagogy or formal Great Books/Socratic discussions (which would strengthen the Classical categorization).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: eloquence in speaking/writing (rhetoric signals), reading/comprehension, classical education—these map to certain classical pedagogical signals (memory, recitation, language focus) present in the public materials (2–4 signals). - Negative keywords present: explicit mention of Socratic seminars, formal logic courses, or Great Books-based seminars are not evident in the public materials. The absence of explicit Socratic pedagogy reduces the strength of a full Classical pedagogy label on the site.

Why this rating - The public content demonstrates pedagogy oriented toward verbal proficiency and core liberal-arts outcomes but lacks explicit documentation of the full range of classical pedagogy (e.g., regular Socratic seminars, rigorous Great Conversations) in the public pages. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Public emphasis on reading/comprehension and eloquence in speaking/writing ; Absence of explicit Socratic pedagogy statements on the public materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials feature a Headmaster’s message and references to faculty roles, but there is limited explicit language about faculty as “models of virtue,” “the living curriculum,” or explicit mentorship culture in the public pages reviewed. The visible pages focus more on mission, vision, and day-to-day school statements rather than explicit character-formation language for teachers (though the presence of the Headmaster and staff often implies a role in the school’s culture) ,.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: The school uses standard teacher-staff references (faculty, headmaster) and parent/community sections; but explicit phrases like “teachers as models of virtue,” “living curriculum,” or “mentorship and collegiality” are not clearly stated in the public materials. - Negative keywords present: The explicit, codified phrases from the Six Essentials (e.g., “living curriculum,” “model teachers,” “mentorship and collegiality”) are not visibly present in the public materials. Absence of these explicit cues lowers the strength of a classical-faculty signal.

Why this rating - The materials show administrative and instructional staff, but do not explicitly articulate the faculty as living curriculum, mentorship, or exemplary models in the language of the classical rubric. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is appropriate given some alignment but lack of explicit declarative signals beyond standard school structure.

Citations: Headmaster’s Message and Vision/Mission (faculty presence in the context of classical aims) ,.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school actively promotes parent involvement and partnership with families: parent information nights, enrollment opportunities, and public-facing “open enrollment” messaging, as well as events and tours. The content explicitly invites parent engagement (e.g., “Parent Information Nights” and open enrollment) and emphasizes that parents are welcome for visits ,. - The public materials present a model of parent-teacher-community engagement consistent with the classical ethos of parental partnership and shared formation in a virtuous education (the explicit “Parent Information Nights” signals co-educator role and ongoing parental education) ,.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: parent information nights, open enrollment, parents welcome to visit (co-teacher partnership signals), community engagement in school life. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The school clearly communicates strong parent involvement and community engagement—core signals of the classical parents-and-community pillar. Therefore CLASSICAL for Element 6.

Citations: Parent Information Nights and enrollment messaging on the public site ; Headmaster messages and community engagement pieces (Headmaster’s page, public events).

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicitly articulate and document a Great Books/Great Conversation framework in curriculum and pedagogy (e.g., scheduled reading lists, core Great Books, and publicly described seminar formats).
 - Create and publish clear statements about Socratic pedagogy in the upper grades (e.g., regular Socratic seminars, seminars, and debates with defined assessment methods).
 - Publicly emphasize theology or sacred/ethical formation in a way that aligns with the charter’s identity (where appropriate), and include liturgical or liturgical-inspired practices if consistent with the community’s values.
 - Clarify and publicize the “living curriculum” concept and faculty mentorship model (teachers as role models, faculty collaboration, and professional formation) to strengthen Element 5.
 - Expand explicit references to “grammar, logic, rhetoric” as a formal curricular progression (K-12) to reinforce Element 3.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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